

Moonsea Rising - 20240421

Gotta Go Back In Time

Combining the powers of the dagger and the chest, General Tuskclaw directs Lirael in the ritual to return them to their own time. Returning to Melvaunt, Lirael performs the ritual. The color rushes out of the world, and their spirits are pulled through a rushing purple twilight.

As they "approach" their own time, something feels wrong. Lirael feels a pain in her missing eye socket, and the dagger pulses in Beitris' hand. So fast it could be mistaken, the colors towards which they are rushing divert to the side, and a different set of colors return to the world.

Looking around, Lirael notices subtle changes to her friends. Taevyn is sporting a scar across his cheek, Lennox looms even larger, Beitris' eyes have lightening to the point of being a dazzling blue rather than their prior dark brown. Even the shade of Harken is altered, sporting shock-white hair and goatee. Lirael seems unaffected, which is somehow even stranger.

Looking down at her hand, Beitris sees she's holding a tarot card depicting the dagger which she had just been holding. The air has a caustic smell, and it tingles in the back of their throats.

Beitris posits that they might not have returned to the present they left, and Taevyn wonders at the heavier make of furniture in the room. Cautiously, they troop out of the rented room, and head down the stairs.

In the common area of the tavern they find the building much the same, but for 200 years of progress. However, "civilized" orcs are interspersed with the other races. Taevyn immediately attempts to draw his rapier. Lirael casts charm on him, but he resists, as Lennox puts his arm around the smaller man, counselling stillness. He points out that this clearly isn't an invasion, and Taevyn's father might well still be alive in this timeline.

Several of the orcs, noticing Lirael, make small gestures in her direction. She returns the gesture of the one-eyed god to them. Lennox suggests they have a drink before exiting, but Lirael and Beitris suggest getting Taevyn out sooner might be better.

Outside, the air is heavy with industrial byproducts. The docks appear to be only half as developed as they remember. The ships have substantial icebreaking gear affixed to them. It clear that the Moonsea is much changed, since Laronen's spell had prevented it from icing over, in the time they came from.

Realizing that the Empire might be much changed, or in fact, nonexistant, they think that perhaps visiting the Temple of Lathandar and checking its archives might be in order.

The smog is choking. Taking inspiration from the locals, the party covers their faces with cloth from their clothing or packs, attempting to filter out the worst of the particulate.

Turning down a side street, they encounter a group of halfings accosting a well-dressed orc. The orc calls out to them for assistance, the lead halfling warns them off, gesturing to several compa-

triot on nearby rooftops.

Beitris immediately moves to cover, drawing her crossbow, as the halflings move to attack. They begin firing crossbows at Taevyn, as Beitris returns fire. One of them hits him a dead-eye shot, and he whirls and spins towards them, attempting to distract their further shots. Sprinting to the nearest attacker, he runs him through with his rapier, wounding the halfling badly. Lennox charges forward, slashing a second one. As they see these two horrific attacks, they turn to flee, Lirael flashing a ray of frost at one, and nearly freezing him in place. They turn and flee headlong down the street.

The injured halfling drops his arms in surrender. The orc congratulates them, and tells them he'll be turned over to the Bruleicos. Guards show up, and the orc, Baron Luther Ironclaw, calls them over. They tell the halfling he'll be hanged for attacking a noble.

The Baron, the Tharan Ambassador, thanks them profusely, and asks if they'll accompany him to the bazaar, and take a meal at his embassy. He enquires after their names, recognizing both Beitris and Lirael's families. He notes that Edric, whom Taevyn asks after, is a character in a card game called "War for the Crown", which he identifies Beitris' card as belonging to. He tells them there is a game shop quite near his friend's store where they can likely acquire more cards.

How Bazaar

Following the Baron to the bazaar, he points them to the game shop, Three Moves Ahead, and tells them he'll send them a dinner invite via the Marsks.

As they approach the game shop, they hear a blood-curdling scream, prompting Taevyn to sprint to the door with rapier drawn. Inside, they find chalk lines smearing in the blood of dead woman. Some giant beast looms over her, and a couple of thugs along the walls call to the monster, "don't worry, Boss. We got this." They charge Taevyn with spears. Taevyn tumbles through them, striking back, they continue to poke him with their spears. Lennox roars and rushes in, swinging his axe. Meanwhile, some presence speaks in Beitris' mind, and when she responds, she winces at its response. The creature glares directly at her. As she casts about for an action to take, Lirael fires a bolt of searing light at it, hitting with a light of burning holy fire. Harken tries to leech its lifeforce with his unholy powers, but the creature laughs off his attempts.

Taevyn spins the spearmen around, stabbing with his rapier. The spearman raises his shield, absorbing some of the blow, but it's still a grievous strike. The spearman attacking Lennox tells him, "the boss is gonna feast on your soul." He attempts to grab the big man, but fails to do so.

Lennox whirls his axe in a wide arc, obliterating both spearman at a stroke. The beast turns its baleful glare on him. Beitris moves forward, calling on Lathandar's blessing, as Lirael fires another searing ray, which misses.

The creature skitters forward, swinging his tail at the three in the building. Taevyn flips the tail, and Lennox knocks it off his shoulder, but Beitris is knocked down. It snaps its jaws at her, but misses. Harken summons a phantasm, but the creature snaps its jaws on it, dispersing it.

As Taevyn looks at the downed Beitris, she yells for him to get out. He tells her, "not until you're clear." He tumbles past the beast, stabbing with his rapier. It clatters off its bones, rattling through

its ribs. Lennox smashes the creature three massive blows with his axe, bones flying apart, and nearly decapitating the beast.

It disappears. Invisibly, its tail lashes Lennox to the floor, and renders Beitris insensate. It chomps down on her, leaving her mangled and near death. In her mind, it gloats, "creature of a weak god, you will learn true power this day."

Harken wafts towards the door, and casts sanctuary on Beitris. He looks for the beast, but doesn't see it. Taevyn pulls out his crossbow, and fires into the beast, hitting it. Lennox rushes it, smashing it with his axe and breaking it to pieces. Its bones immediately begin sinking through the floor.

As Beitris heals herself, Harken looks at the chalk drawings on the floor, wondering aloud, "why is it a map of Melvaunt?" Two different colored lines appear to track something moving from the docks, and something coming from the east gate. The path from the docks appears to follow the party's actions. Beitris' card still seems to point to the northwest.

Exploring the room to the north, they find a number of games, including lower-quality copies of cards similar to Beitris'. In a nearby ledger, they also find a similarly high-quality card representing Laronen. Beitris' card follows Laronen's around, though his card seems inert.

Looking at the ledger, they find a name circled, Dieral Myrnese.

Back in the main room, Harken speaks with the memories of the deceased spearman. They tell him that they were tracking the cards. They are from War for the Crown, but the ones they were tracking are special. There are a dozen in a full deck.

Sifting through the cards, they find cards for the Mage, the Dagger, the Quartermaster, the Drake Talon, the Emperor, the Zhent, the Mad Kind, the Chieftan, the General, the Chest, the Temple, and the Druid.